Customer Data Governance & GDPR Risk Assessment

Marilena Blanchi | Independent portfolio project

NovaRetail Europe | Excel · PostgreSQL / SQL · Tableau

Project overview

This project looks at how a fictional retail company could identify data quality problems and gaps in the way customer information is managed. I used a small synthetic dataset to check records, review consent evidence, assess governance risks and present the results in a dashboard.

What I wanted to find out

Are customer records complete and up to date? Is there a clear owner, classification and retention period for each data asset? Are consent records documented properly? Which issues should be reviewed first?

How I worked

Excel: Organised sample data, applied quality checks, reviewed consent records and built a risk register.

PostgreSQL / SQL: Queried customer records to identify missing values, duplicates and summary counts.

Tableau: Built a dashboard to show the main findings.

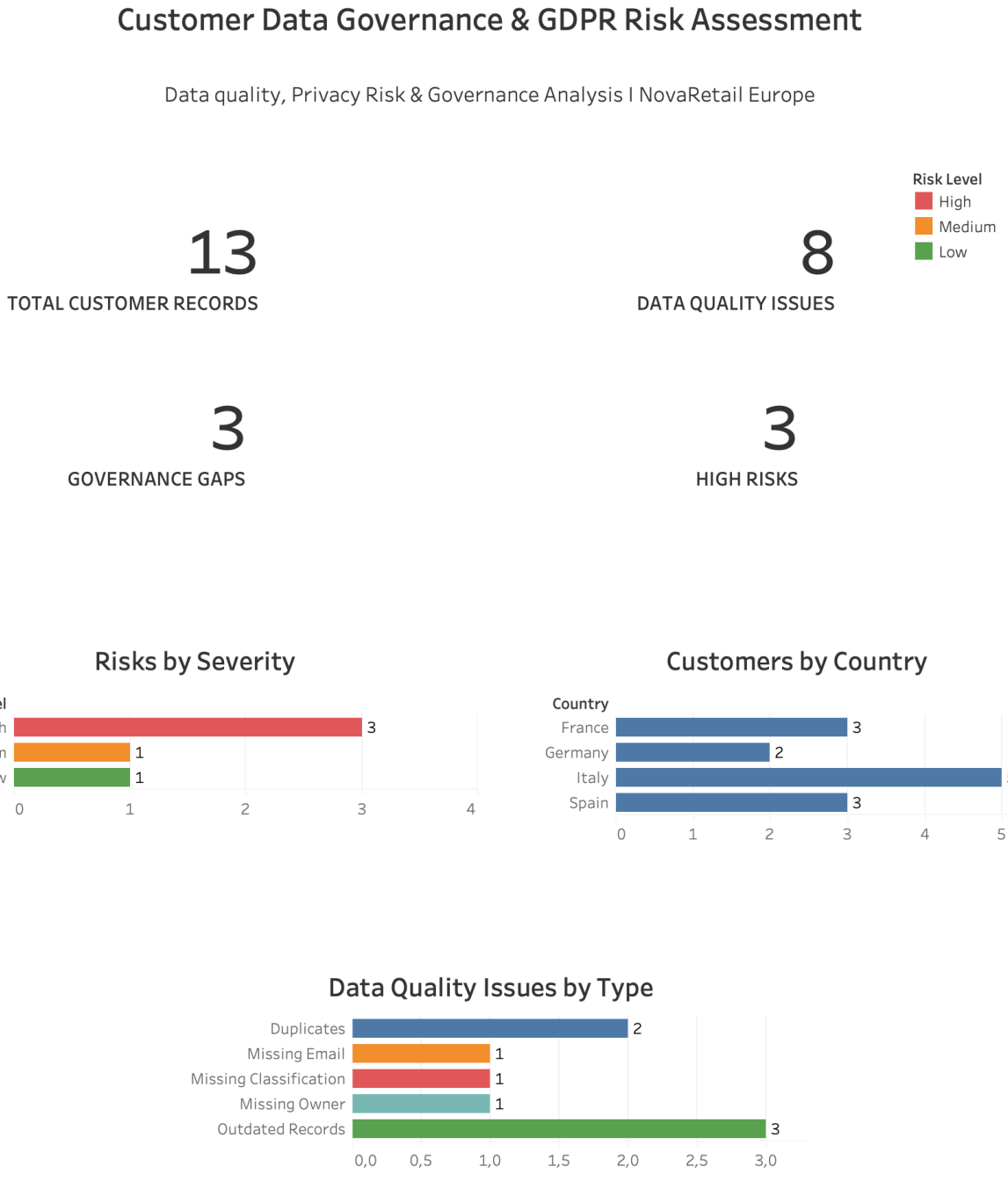
Results at a glance

13	8	3	3
Customer records	Quality issue flags	Governance gaps	High-rated risks

The eight data quality issues count flagged conditions, not necessarily eight different customers. Risk ratings are part of this simulation.

A quick view of the findings

Tableau dashboard based on the project dataset.



The dashboard shows customer records, quality issue flags, governance gaps and high-rated risks. It also breaks down risk severity, customers by country and the main data quality issues.

What the analysis showed

Data quality

The checks flagged two records involved in a duplicate, one missing email, one missing classification, one missing owner and three outdated records. Some records may have more than one issue.

Governance and privacy

The data inventory shows three gaps: missing classification, missing ownership and an undocumented retention period. The consent review found a granted consent without a date and a withdrawn consent without a recorded withdrawal date.

Risk assessment

I recorded five risks: three High, one Medium and one Low. The three High risks relate to missing data classification, missing consent dates and missing withdrawal dates. Scores are based on likelihood and impact values used in the exercise.

Recommended actions

1. Assign a named data owner and confirm classification for each relevant asset.
2. Document and review retention periods, starting with Website Analytics.
3. Improve checks for consent and withdrawal dates.
4. Review duplicate and outdated records, and repeat quality checks regularly.
5. Track open risks, assign responsibility and record when issues are resolved.

What I learned

This project helped me connect data analysis with governance and privacy work. I practised turning spreadsheet checks and SQL results into a risk register and a dashboard that a non-technical colleague could understand.

Project files

Excel data quality checks and risk register · PostgreSQL SQL queries · Tableau dashboard · Project documentation

Project note: NovaRetail Europe is fictional. All data is synthetic and was created for learning and portfolio purposes. The findings do not establish actual GDPR non-compliance.